

Preparatory Assignment 1

Practice: The Method (Portrait of Nell Gwyn)

Points: 10**Due: Jan 26, 2026**

Read the assigned section from *WA* (pp. 22-43), that goes over the five analytical moves, paying special attention to "Notice & Focus (+Ranking)", "Asking 'So What?'" , and "the Method".

Then do a version of what the textbook has demonstrated with the painting, *Whistler's Mother* (pp. 39-41), on a painting of one of our actresses, Nell Gwyn. Your goal is to produce an analysis of the portrait with the steps included in analyzing *Whistler's Mother*.

- First, summarize the portrait, describing accurately its significant details. Do not go beyond a recounting of what the portrait includes; avoid interpreting what these details suggest (min. 50 words).
- Then use the various methods offered in this chapter to analyze the data (as many words as necessary—the more thorough the better).
 - What repetitions (patterns of same or similar detail) do you see?
 - What organizing contrasts suggest themselves?
 - Considering these patterns of similarity and difference, what anomalies do you then begin to detect?
 - Move from the data to interpretive conclusions.
- This process will produce a set of interpretive leaps, which you may then try to assemble into a more coherent claim of some sort—a short paragraph about what the portrait “says” (min. 70 words).

Use of AI in this assignment will result in a report of Academic Dishonesty.